THE WHITE HOUSE

WASHINGTON

March 8, 1972

MEMORANDUM FOR THE PRESIDENT'S FILE

RE : Meeting with Secretary Rogers
February 26, 1972 - Shanghai

FROM : H.R. HALDEMAN

The Secretary arrived at the President's suite in the Shanghai guest house unannounced and said he wanted to meet with the President. The President asked me to sit in on the meeting.

The Secretary outlined his concern that there was serious adverse publicity about his role in the visit, especially relating to the fact that he had been left out of the meeting with Chairman Mao.

It was obvious that the Secretary's total concern was with the press stories and the appearances that they created that he was not playing as important a role as he should be in the visit. There seemed to be no concern on his part about the problems that the President and Dr. Kissinger had been going through on putting the communique together, although the Secretary did indicate that there would be a number of problems with the communique and that he was concerned about his ability to deal with those in his testimony before the Senate and House since he had not had a principle role in drafting the communique.

Both the President and I pointed out that the Secretary's suggested corrections in the final draft had been incorporated by Dr. Kissinger through enormous effort, running through almost the entire previous night, an effort that required the Chinese to make substantial changes after the whole document had been agreed upon by their politburo.

The Secretary also urged that a meeting be held between the President and Secretary Green before Green took off on his trip to the other Asian nations, and that the point be clearly made that (to the press) Green had met with the President and that the Secretary had met with Chou En-lai and was meeting with the Foreign Minister again tomorrow morning.

The clear impression from everything covered by the Secretary in this meeting was that his total concern here was not one of substance in any way, but rather one of the appearances created primarily by his omission from the Mao meeting. He didn't seem to understand even after considerable discussion, the circumstances that led to the Mao meeting, and he's obviously very disturbed by the press reports which have built strongly on his absence, as an indication of the downgrading of the Department and of the Secretary.